



Taylor Star

HIRED SANTA

Ho, ho... who?

FOR TAYLOR STAR'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

WHO YOU ARE

An actor hired to play Santa tonight. You've been by the tree all evening, handing out presents.

COSTUME

Easy: Santa suit, or an elf costume.
Go all out: the full Santa suit with a fluffy beard, or a velvet elf costume with striped stockings and a bell.

PUBLIC RELATIONSHIPS

- **Morgan Ivy:** booked you for the party
- **Charlie Bell:** keeps asking you to pose for photos
- **Everyone else:** you've only just met them, ho ho

WHAT YOU WANT TONIGHT

- Stay in character as Santa all night
- Hear every bit of gossip in the room
- Find out who's been naughty, and who's been nice

THE PARTY

Christmas Eve at Snowbury Lodge. The Frost & Fable Toy Company is having its annual party, and its founder, Nicholas "Nick" Frost, is about to raise his favourite red mug for the 9 o'clock toast. Snow is falling. The road is about to close.

YOUR NIGHT AT A GLANCE

1. Arrive

Read this cover and "Before the game". Put on your name tag.

2. Rounds 1–3

Each round: reveal, ask your questions, do your mini task.

3. Accuse

Fill in a ballot: who, how and why.

4. Awards

Best Detective, Best Costume and Best Liar.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES



Before the game

You're an actor hired to play Santa tonight. You've been beside the tree all evening.

YOUR SECRET

A MegaMart executive paid you \$200 to report any gossip from the party. You've been texting them all night.

You are innocent

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

- Read "Before the game" now. Read each round only when Inspector Noel starts it.
- Each round gives you something to reveal, questions to ask and a mini task. Do them all, in any order, while you mingle.
- You may keep your secret until your booklet tells you to reveal it. You may not lie about anything on an evidence card, unless your booklet says otherwise.
- Stuck? Ask someone a question from your list, or go and look at the evidence table.

Playing Taylor



Your manner: Jolly, theatrical and nosy. Stay in Santa (or elf) character as long as you can: ho-ho-ho, ask who's been naughty, and keep sneaking looks at your phone.

LINES TO TRY

- "Ho, ho... who's been naughty tonight?"
- "Santa sees everything from beside the tree."
- "Sorry, just checking on the reindeer."
(Check your phone.)

IF SOMEONE ACCUSES YOU

- Stay in character: "Santa? A poisoner? On Christmas Eve? Ho, ho, no!"

FIRST IMPRESSIONS: WHO SEEMS NERVOUS? WHOSE STORY SOUNDS REHEARSED?

Rounds 1 & 2



Round 1



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 1

Play it like this: Stay jolly. Admit you were by the tree from 6:30.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- Lots of gifts arrived under the tree between 6:30 and 7:00.
- Gossip: when you asked Nick what he wanted for Christmas, he said "a quiet retirement".

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan who booked Santa, and why.
- Ask Alex what they shouted at Nick at about 8:00. You heard it from the tree.

MINI TASK

In character as Santa, ask three people what they want for Christmas. Note any answer that sounds like a motive.

Round 2



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 2

Play it like this: Share what you saw: at about 6:45, while you were adjusting your beard, someone in a **green workshop apron** slipped a small box with a red velvet ribbon under the tree.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- The box was small, about the size of a bottle.
- You remember the ribbon clearly: red velvet, tied in a neat bow.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Morgan which gifts under the tree were for Nick.
- Ask Jamie whether Nick had a sweet tooth.

MINI TASK

Give a "naughty or nice" verdict on two suspects, and explain why.

CONVERSATION TRACKER: TICK EVERYONE YOU'VE QUESTIONED

- | | | | |
|--|--|---------------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Robin Holly | ☐ Jordan Tinsel | ☐ Sam Garland | ☐ Casey Sleigh |
| ☐ Alex Snow | ☐ Morgan Ivy | ☐ Charlie Bell | ☐ Frankie Fir |
| ☐ Quinn Mistletoe | ☐ Jamie Pudding | ☐ Riley Carol | ☐ Inspector Noel |

Round 3 & notes



Round 3



Read only when Inspector Noel starts Round 3

Play it like this: Confess the MegaMart texts if pressed. They show that MegaMart wanted the deal to go through, and a dead Nick puts it at risk.

REVEAL OR GOSSIP

- MegaMart wanted the sale to go through. Nick dead puts it at risk.
- You keep checking your phone. Somebody will notice.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

- Ask Jordan what the sale means now that Nick is gone.
- Ask Quinn whether the press already knew about MegaMart.

MINI TASK

Before ballots, read out "Santa's list": who has been naughty tonight (not necessarily the culprit).

BEFORE YOU VOTE

Look at the evidence table one last time. Your ballot needs who, how and why, plus the clue that convinced you.

NOTES

Suspects at Snowbury Lodge

Robin Holly · Head Toymaker
 Sam Garland · Nick's Nephew or Niece
 Alex Snow · Rival Toymaker
 Taylor Star · Hired Santa
 Frankie Fir · Lodge Gardener
 Jamie Pudding · Village Baker
 Inspector Noel · the host

Jordan Tinsel · Finance Director
 Casey Sleigh · Caterer
 Morgan Ivy · Personal Assistant
 Charlie Bell · Marketing Manager
 Quinn Mistletoe · Journalist
 Riley Carol · Hired Pianist
 Nick Frost · the victim